

CLAUDE CODE × SERVICENOW SDK

Video 3: Create, Build & Deploy

Scaffold a New App, Write Fluent Code with AI, Deploy to Instance

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Prerequisites

- Videos 1 and 2 completed (environment set up, authenticated)
- Auth profile saved and working (now-sdk dependencies succeeds)

Step 1 — Scaffold a New Project

1a. Create a project folder

```
mkdir ~/Desktop/it-asset-tracker
```

```
cd ~/Desktop/it-asset-tracker
```

1b. Initialize with the SDK

```
now-sdk init
```

The init wizard walks you through these prompts:

Prompt	What to Enter
Template	Select: now-sdk (basic Fluent template)
App name	IT Asset Tracker (or your preferred name)
Auth profile	Select your saved profile (e.g., mydev)

1c. Explore the generated structure

```
ls -la
```

You should see:

- now.config.json — app scope and configuration
- package.json — SDK dependencies and build scripts
- tsconfig.json — TypeScript compiler settings
- src/ — folder where your Fluent code goes

1d. Check your app scope

```
cat now.config.json
```

Note the scope value (e.g., `x_snc_it_asset`). All table and column names must use this prefix.

Step 2 — Launch Claude Code & Generate the App

2a. Start Claude Code

```
claude
```

2b. Give Claude your app requirements

Paste the following prompt (or modify to your needs):

Create a ServiceNow app with the following:

1. A table called IT Assets with these fields:

- `asset_name` (string, max 200 chars)
- `asset_tag` (string, mandatory, max 100 chars)
- `category` (choice: Hardware, Software, Network)
- `assigned_to` (reference to `sys_user`)
- `purchase_date` (date_time)
- `status` (choice: Active, Retired, In Repair, default Active)

2. An application menu with modules:

- All IT Assets (full list)
- Active Assets (filtered to status = Active)

3. A business rule: when status changes to Retired, automatically clear the `assigned_to` field

2c. What Claude generates

Claude will create these files in src/fluent/:

- tables/it-assets.now.ts — table definition with all fields
- navigation/app-menu.now.ts — application menu and modules
- business-rules/retire-clear-assignee.now.ts — business rule logic

TIP: Review the generated code. Claude automatically uses the correct scope prefix from `now.config.json`, the object syntax for `ChoiceColumn`, and unique `$id` values for every element.

Step 3 — Build the App

```
now-sdk build
```

This compiles your Fluent TypeScript into metadata XML in the `metadata/` folder.

If the build succeeds, you'll see a success message. If it fails:

1. Copy the error message
2. Paste it back to Claude Code
3. Claude will fix the issue using the troubleshooting knowledge from the `sndev` skill
4. Re-run: `now-sdk build`

Common build errors and fixes

Error	Fix
no exported member HTMLColumn	Use <code>HtmlColumn</code> (lowercase tml)
value not in ChoiceConfig	Use <code>{ key: { label } }</code> not array
table does not exist on createRecord	Use <code>table_name:</code> and <code>TemplateValue({})</code>
Duplicate \$id	Every <code>Now.ID</code> key must be unique

Step 4 — Deploy to Your Instance

```
now-sdk install --auth mydev
```

This packages the metadata and pushes it to your ServiceNow instance. It typically takes 30–60 seconds.

TIP: Add `--open-browser true` to automatically open the app in your browser after install.

Step 5 — Verify on Your Instance

1. Open your ServiceNow instance in a browser
2. In the Application Navigator, type your app name (e.g., “IT Asset”)
3. You should see your application menu with both modules
4. Click “All IT Assets” — the table list view opens
5. Click “New” to create a test record — fill in the fields
6. Test the business rule: change status to “Retired” and save — assigned_to should clear automatically

Congratulations — you just built and deployed a ServiceNow app using only natural language.

Quick Reference: The Development Cycle

Step	Command	What Happens
1. Init	<code>now-sdk init</code>	Scaffolds project structure
2. Code	<code>claude</code> (then describe what you want)	Claude writes Fluent TypeScript
3. Build	<code>now-sdk build</code>	Compiles to metadata XML
4. Deploy	<code>now-sdk install --auth <alias></code>	Pushes to your instance
5. Verify	Open instance in browser	Test your app